

Scenario 3 - SOC Incident Investigation Report

Executive Summary

Investigation identified a True Positive security incident involving privileged account abuse, creation of unauthorized accounts, administrator group modification, persistence establishment, and audit log clearing.

Alert Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE (TP)

Severity

CRITICAL

Affected Host

Windows Endpoint

Primary Suspicious IP

198.51.100.50

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IP Address: 198.51.100.50

Accounts: helpdesk, backupsvc, auditadmin

Events: 4720, 4732, 4672, 4688, 1102

Attack Timeline

09:02:30 - helpdesk remote logon (4624)
09:03:05 - Special privileges assigned (4672)
09:05:11 - backupsvc account created (4720)
09:05:45 - backupsvc added to Administrators (4732)
09:06:10 - Password changed for backupsvc (4723)
09:07:15 - backupsvc logged in (4624)
09:09:15 - net.exe executed to create auditadmin (4688)
09:09:50 - auditadmin account created (4720)
09:10:25 - auditadmin logged in (4624)
09:12:05 - Audit logs cleared (1102)

MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

T1078 - Valid Accounts

T1136 - Create Account

T1098 - Account Manipulation

TA0003 - Persistence

T1070 - Indicator Removal on Host

Findings

1. Multiple unauthorized accounts created.
2. Administrative privileges granted.
3. Persistence established through new accounts.
4. Audit logs cleared indicating defense evasion.
5. Activity originated from 198.51.100.50.

Containment Recommendations

Disable helpdesk, backupsvc and auditadmin accounts.

Reset credentials.

Block 198.51.100.50.

Collect forensic artifacts and preserve logs.

Review lateral movement and domain activity.